

*Serious Sam II* (SSII) does absolutely nothing new here. Yes, the game looks a lot better with great graphics—the backgrounds are breathtaking, but the enemies are as stupid and funnily designed as ever. Unlike *Doom* or *Quake*, where first sight of the aliens can send a chill down your spine, in SSII you're more likely to burst uncontrollably into peals of laughter!

The weapons are as hilarious as ever, including a parrot that carries a pretty deadly bomb, kamikaze style! The level design is somewhat monotonous, and the guns are bigger than ever. However, the arcade feel to the game means that your big guns can obliterate the enemy by the hundreds, but three seconds later their bodies (or whatever was left of them) vanish, leaving no trace of the carnage you just unleashed. This can be really unsatisfying.

The things that remain unchanged from the first game, such as the way you're attacked by charging bulls or headless kamikazes, along with jets that drop bombs and huge monsters that fire from a distance, are only so much fun. Once you realise that running backwards blowing everything that approaches your away is the key, you pretty much do that through the whole game.

SSII is a good laugh, and can entertain you for a day or two. Then it gets boring, and none of that breathtaking scenery can make up for silly bosses and easy-to-kill monsters. It's strictly a game for the die-hard *Serious Sam* fans. You also need good hardware to render the hundreds of enemies and the scenery. At least there's some physics incorporated into the game this time!



*Serious Sam* is anything but serious!